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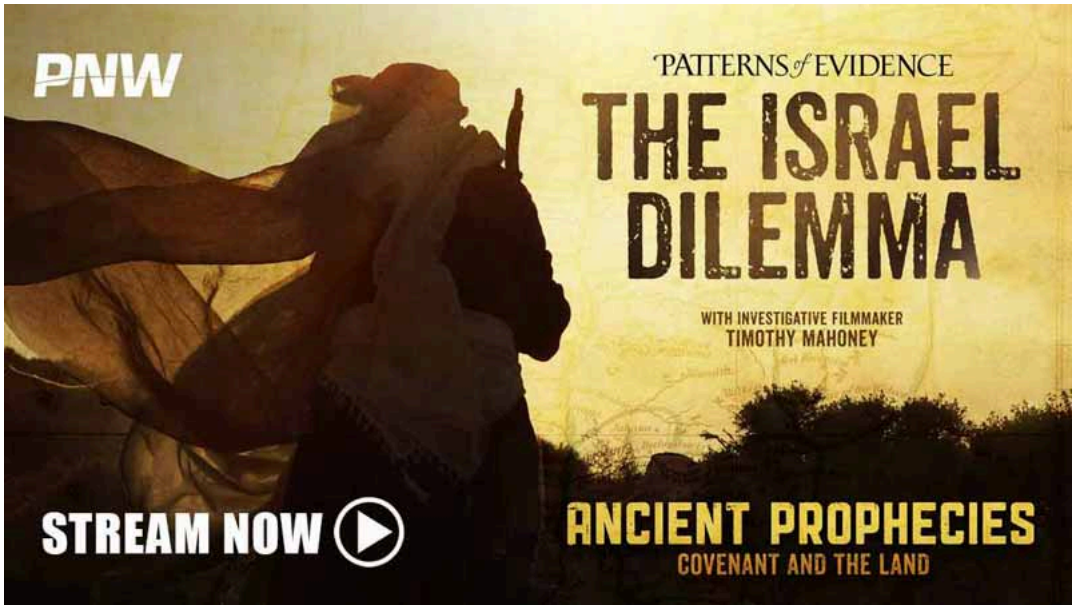

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ARTICLE

Secular Fear Meets Bible Prophecy: One Third Believe The End Is Near

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BY PNW STAFF MARCH 17, 2026

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Something remarkable is happening in the public consciousness. In an age defined by technology, scientific advancement, and confidence in human progress, a growing number of people sense that history may be approaching a dramatic turning point. According to a recent study conducted by researchers at the University of British Columbia, nearly one-third of Americans and Canadians believe the world will end within their lifetime.

For many observers, that statistic may sound shocking. But for millions of Christians who have long studied biblical prophecy, the idea that people increasingly sense the world is moving toward some kind of final chapter may not be surprising at all.

For centuries, Scripture has taught that history is not random. The Bible describes a clear beginning, a purposeful unfolding of events, and ultimately a conclusion in which God intervenes decisively in human history. Jesus Himself warned that before the end comes, the world would experience rising turmoil--wars, instability, moral confusion, and distress among nations. Whether people believe in the Bible or not, it is difficult to ignore how often modern headlines seem to echo those warnings.

The new survey found that about 28.9 percent of respondents believe the world will end during their lifetime. Younger participants were even more likely to hold that view. Researchers were interested in how these beliefs shape public attitudes toward global threats such as nuclear conflict, climate concerns, or other large-scale crises.

But the most fascinating element of the study may be what it unintentionally reveals about how people interpret the future.

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In other words, the way people think about the end of the world dramatically shapes how they respond to the problems of the present.

For Christians, that distinction matters deeply. Biblical prophecy does not teach that humanity will destroy the world through technology or environmental collapse. Instead, Scripture describes a future in which human rebellion, geopolitical conflict, and spiritual deception intensify until God ultimately intervenes. That message does not produce panic--it produces vigilance.

Interestingly, the survey also highlighted another pattern that aligns with what many pastors already observe. While belief in the end of the world tends to decline as people age in most groups, it does not decline among Evangelical Protestants. In fact, in some cases it increases.

That difference is not rooted in conspiracy theories or cultural pessimism. It is rooted in something far simpler: Evangelical Christians tend to read and study biblical prophecy more frequently than many other groups. For them, the expectation that history is moving toward a divinely appointed conclusion is not speculation. It is part of their theological framework.

But that raises an important challenge for the modern church.

For decades, many pastors and Christian leaders have avoided teaching about prophecy altogether, fearing that it can be controversial or easily misunderstood. Yet the growing cultural fascination with apocalyptic ideas suggests that people are already thinking about the end of the world--just often without a biblical lens.

When secular culture talks about the future, it usually frames the end as pure catastrophe: climate collapse, nuclear devastation, or technological disaster. These narratives offer fear but little hope. The Bible, however, tells a different story.

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It is the culmination of God's plan for history.

The rising belief that the world may be nearing its end could easily be dismissed as anxiety or cultural pessimism. But it may also reveal something deeper about the human condition. Even in a secular age, many people instinctively feel that history is moving somewhere--that the story of the world has an ending.

For the church, that awareness presents an opportunity. If nearly a third of people already believe the world may end in their lifetime, then the conversation about the future is already happening.

The question is whether Christians will step into that conversation.

Because when the world begins asking whether the end is near, the church should be ready with an answer--not one of fear, but one rooted in the promises of Scripture. The Bible does not call believers to panic about the future. It calls them to watch, to remain faithful, and to remember that the final chapter of history ultimately belongs to God.

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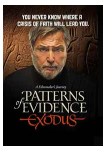

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